

The Pause-and-Repair Protocol (The Whole Thing on One Page)

The complete tool from You Yelled. Now What? by Simon Gebhart.

This page is the book. If you skipped straight here, you can run everything from this checklist — each part carries its evidence tag, and the chapters behind you hold the details and the caveats.

Part 1 — The trigger ledger (5 minutes, once)

(Tag: design requirement — pauses are planned per-trigger in advance; nothing in this protocol is summoned mid-flood.)

- [] Name your **top two collisions**: time + task + kid. ("5:40pm, shoes, the six-year-old." "8:00pm, teeth, the toddler.") Not "I have no patience" — a specific, scheduled collision you can see coming.
- [] Work the **most frequent** one first. Reps build skills; frequency is where the reps are.

Part 2 — The planned pause

(Tag: a skill of the kind trained by the structured programs in an independent Cochrane review — 13 trials, children aged 3–12, harsh parenting down 0.77 SMD by parent report, confirmed at 0.42 by independent observers. Those were multi-week programs; the pause is one move from that family of skills, not the trial-tested whole.)

- [] **Announce line**, said out loud, pre-scripted: "I'm getting loud inside. I'm taking two minutes." Announced, never stormed — regulation, not rejection.
- [] **Exit**: another room, the doorway, or a full turn-away with hands on the counter.
- [] **Two minutes on a real timer**, spent lowering arousal — not building the case file. Prosecution during the break is the break failing.
- [] **Re-entry line**, pre-scripted, restating the boundary at low volume: "I'm back. Shoes still need to go on. Let's go."

Part 3 — The two-minute repair

(Tag: early evidence, one 96-dyad preschool study — ordinary pairs repaired only about half their negative moments, and higher repair likelihood predicted better child emotion regulation four months later. The four-beat script is an application built from this literature, not itself a trialed intervention.)

- [] **Beat 1 — Name it**: "I yelled. That was too loud." No "sorry you got upset."
- [] **Beat 2 — Own it, keep the boundary**: "That was my temper, not your fault — and the shoes still needed to go on."
- [] **Beat 3 — Reconnect on their terms**: hug offered not extracted, or just sit nearby.
- [] **Beat 4 — State the plan**: "Next time I'm taking my two minutes first."
- [] **Variants**: toddler — six words, physical, present tense ("Mama got too loud. You're safe. Hug?"). School-age — the four beats. Teen — two sentences, no forced moment; the plan only counts when they see it happen.
- [] **Timing**: same night beats next morning; next morning beats never; never is the only wrong answer.

Part 4 — The loop-breaker rule

(Tag: 976-family longitudinal study — the escalation loop ran both ways: harsher verbal discipline predicted more misbehavior a year later, and misbehavior predicted more yelling. You own one arrow; the protocol breaks yours, before the moment and after it.)

- [] Track exactly two numbers: **yells-per-week trend** (down is winning) and **repairs-per-yell** (this one can hit 100%).
- [] **Zero yells is not the bar. Zero *unrepaired* yells is.**
- [] **Relapse rule:** a blown day costs one repair, not the method. Run the script, close the day, done.

The boundary line, at the bottom of the page where it belongs: the pause defends the rule at lower volume. Nothing in this protocol means the shoes don't go on.

Do this now: Print or screenshot this page and put it where your trigger lives — taped inside the kitchen cabinet for the 5:40 collision, clipped to the car visor for the school run, on the bathroom mirror for bathtime. The protocol works at the scene, not in the book.

More printable cards like this, free: [Simon Gebhart's Field Notes](#)

The full guide: amazon.com/dp/BOHL1RL7VJ